

Promiscuous Grace and Premeditated Repentance

John Wrote These Things So Believers Would Stop Sinning

Beginning with 1 John 2:1-2, which reads this way:

My little children, these things write I unto you, that ye sin not.
And if any man sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous:
And he is the propitiation for our sins:
and not for ours only, but also for the sins of the whole world.

I want to invite you to pay very close attention. This is not the kind of sequence you can break down and think, "I will listen awhile and pick it up later." Wrong. One verse spawns the meaning of the next. One revelation is built upon another, line upon line. You must hang on.

When He opened this to me, it broke my heart that this has been in this chapter for two thousand years, and I had just seen it a couple of months ago. It makes me wonder what I have been doing.

Amen?

John says, "My little children, these things write I unto you, that ye sin not." Stop for a moment. Something he said in the first chapter was written to keep them from sinning. Whatever that was, if I can understand it, it will also keep me from sinning.

He says, "If any man sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous." He is the propitiation for our sins, and he is talking about the believer now, because he wrote this entire first chapter so we would not sin. The information he provided was so we would understand what sin is and avoid it.

Jesus Christ is not only the advocate of the believer, but also the propitiation for the sins of the whole world. He has been set forth crucified for the world. But in this chapter, we are not the sinner in the world; we are believers. This first chapter is dealing with you and me.

So what information did John provide so that we would not sin?

Promiscuous Grace Uses Doctrine to Protect a Sinful Lifestyle

God is going to fulfill prophecy. It is as simple as that. The book of Revelation is going to come to pass. God is going to work what He is going to work in America, whether you like it or not. Where faith comes in is whether you will be in the cursed camp or the blessed camp.

When I asked, "God, what got our country into this mess?" He said, "Because the rock, the foundation of America, has left the fundamentals of the Church and holiness and has elected to immorality."

I said, "Whose fault is it?"

He said, "It is the Church's fault."

From that point on, He began to warn me. The teacher in me will not let me keep this on a general basis, to the United States as a whole. The teacher in me makes me pull it right down to the level you and I walk on, the gut level. How am I going to help my nation if I do not do something about me?

He began to issue me a warning. He said, "This is the thing to watch for in the Church." I finally had to give it a name: promiscuous grace.

I am not for legalistic holiness, but I am for a man giving his life to God and serving Him in the holiness of the nature of God. That does not include sin.

Promiscuous grace is people arguing grace as a reason not to be condemned for a promiscuous lifestyle.

He told me that a man quits walking into his salvation and begins walking out when he looks to the Word and begins to argue the Word and grace as a reason that his sinful lifestyle is being covered. He is searching the Word, grace, and God for a reason not to quit sinning.

At that point, my friend, you are not walking into God anymore. You have crossed the line. You are walking back out.

If you do not think you can lose God in your life, you had better study the book of Jude, where he says those trees have no fruit, are twice dead, and are plucked up by the roots. He is talking about an existing tree being plucked up by the roots. Twice dead. How can a living man be twice dead? I can tell you: he was spiritually dead, then born again, then died again.

When you turn around and begin to walk out of God, there will be a day when you too cross the line.

Let me tell you something about sin. When you start tasting sin and wanting to walk in sin and walk in God, pretty soon you will get so far out into sin that it destroys your willpower to want to come back. It is not that He will not take you back every time you bawl at the altar. It is not that He does not forgive you every time you ask Him earnestly from your heart. The problem is that next week you find yourself back in the same mess because you have no more fortification in your will to finish walking out of it. That is what kills you.

Go on, play with the snake. He will not stay a baby forever. Play with him. He will grow up.

He said, "Watch for people preaching this promiscuous grace, because it removes from people the willpower to want to live free from sin."

Premeditated Repentance Packs Forgiveness as Fire Insurance

The second thing He told me to watch for was premeditated repentance.

What is premeditated repentance? It is when you pack a bottle of repent pills in your overnight bag for a weekend of sin, along with your Tylenol.

I know what some of you are thinking. You are looking around at the empty seats and saying, "No wonder."

Premeditated repentance is when you pack a little bottle of repent pills with the bottle of Tylenol. Monday morning you wake up, and the repent pills are for the premeditated sin while the Tylenol is for the headache. As you swallow both, you say to yourself, "God, I confess it is sin because You are faithful and just to forgive me and cleanse me from all unrighteousness. Thank You for forgiving me, but I sure am looking forward to next weekend."

Premeditated repentance does not work. The main reason is that in order to repent, you have to have faith. Repent means to turn from it. God accepts your repentance when you determine in your heart that you are going to walk out of the sin, not into it.

Premeditated repentance was not designed to cover sin as fire insurance. It was designed as the faith to release you from sin when you make up your mind to walk out of it.

This brings us to our chapter. John goes into the second chapter declaring that Jesus Christ is not only the propitiation for our sins, the believers, but also for the sins of the whole world. And he declared, "I have written these things so that you will stop sinning."

What things did he write that will stop me from sinning?

In this chapter he covered promiscuous grace and premeditated repentance. The reason he opened this up is so I would quit sinning.

One man told me, "I was doing a systematic breakdown of 1, 2, and 3 John, and I got halfway through 1 John and abandoned the whole project. The chapter was too legalistic for me. I could not find grace in it."

Abandoning it is not going to make it go away.

Walking in Darkness While Claiming Fellowship Is a Lie

First John 1:6 says:

If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth.

What is the first thing John covers? Promiscuous grace.

"Brother Roberson, what kind of darkness is he talking about? Do you mind defining darkness?"

Not at all. Go to 1 John 2:15:

Love not the world, neither the things that are in the world.
If any man love the world, the love of the Father is not in him.
For all that is in the world,
the lust of the flesh,
and the lust of the eyes,
and the pride of life,
is not of the Father, but is of the world.

That is darkness.

Back to verse 6:

If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth.

Verse 7:

But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light,
we have fellowship one with another,
and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin.

If we say we have fellowship with the Father God and walk in darkness, the lusts of the flesh and the world, we lie and do not the truth. But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship one with another: us with the Father and us with each other. Then the blood of Jesus Christ His Son cleanses us from all sin.

Verse 8 says:

If we say that we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.

I have heard preachers preach this as though it covered the existence of every man, woman, and child, as if to say that if we deny having a lower nature trying to escape through our flesh and make us sin, we lie. They say every man is a sinner.

But that is not what this is talking about. You have to take the verse out of context to make it say that. The context is verses 6, 7, and 8:

If we say we have fellowship with Him and walk in darkness, we lie and do not the truth. If a man is in that condition, living a life of promiscuous grace, claiming everything is covered under grace while he is walking in darkness, then for him to say he has no sin means he has deceived himself.

That is who John is talking about. If we are walking in darkness, claiming fellowship with the Father, and claiming, "I do not have sin," he says we have deceived ourselves and the truth is not in us.

Confession Calls the Whole Mess Sin So Cleansing Can Deliver It

Verse 9 says:

If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins,
and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

Then verse 10:

If we say that we have not sinned, we make him a liar,
and his word is not in us.

In verse 6 we have promiscuous grace. In verse 9 we have premeditated repentance. Notice verse 9 closely. If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and not only to forgive us, but to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

It is interesting that He made a division between forgiveness and cleansing. Along with my forgiveness, I would like to be delivered from the problem.

What is the cleansing? It is when you take the scouring powder, not only kill the cockroach, but scrub him off the counter. He is faithful and just, or justified, not only in forgiving us but in cleansing us, which is delivering us.

"I have to sin, Brother Roberson."

Oh no, you do not. Sin shall have no more dominion over you because you are not under the law, my friend, but under grace. What the law could not do in that it was weak through the flesh, God sent His own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh, that the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us who walk not after the flesh but after the Spirit.

I do not have to sin. He set me free. Sin will have no more dominion over me, and it cannot make me do what I refuse to do.

"You do not understand. The temptation was much too great for me. I could not bear up under it."

No, you do not understand:

There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man:
but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able;
but will with the temptation also make a way to escape.

Your first step out of dominance is to stand up and spit right in the devil's face and tell him, "I do not care if I think I could not help it. I do not care if you think I could not help it. I do not care if everybody in the whole world says I did not have any choice. Devil, I want you to know that neither you nor my flesh can make me do what I will not do, for sin shall have no more dominion over me."

What was John saying? The man who walks in darkness while claiming fellowship with the Father is practicing promiscuous grace. He thinks premeditated repentance works because he says, "All that sin is under the blood." But John says if you are walking in darkness and claiming fellowship with Him, and in that condition say you have no sin, you have deceived yourself.

If you confess your sin, He is faithful and just to forgive and cleanse you.

Confess what? This is not merely reading off a list after a weekend of sin. Confession means that if you are walking in darkness and claiming fellowship with God, you must reevaluate your doctrine, straighten yourself out, and call sin sin. Confess it for what it is. Say, "That sin is not light, and grace does not cover my promiscuous lifestyle."

Confess the whole mess as sin. Then you will have faith to receive forgiveness, and He will cleanse you from all unrighteousness.

Sin Lost Dominion, but Excuses Still Give It Room

I used to love to teach that I was a late starter. I was thirty years old when I answered the call and started out of the gate. Everybody would say, "I am a strong finisher." Well, I am. I might be slow, but I am picking up momentum. Hell is going to pay, and I am not boasting; I am speaking. Let the weak say they are strong. I know where my strength comes from.

Watch out, hell, because you are going to pay real badly. Take my word.

I used to like to say I was a late starter until God took me back through my life and said, "Son, every time you turned your back on Me and went with the flesh, you did not have to."

"I did not have any Word. I got born again the first time and had no Word."

He said, "Yes, but you were born again. You had My nature. You had the Holy Spirit, and you still turned your back on Me and went with the flesh."

"But..."

He said, "No. It did not have dominion over you. The difference between you and the people breaking in ahead of you is that when you failed back there, they did not."

He told me a long time ago that if I was going to do anything for God, I had to give up the luxury of excuses. I did not know what that meant then. I do now.

I do what I want to do, whether it is for God or not. I do what I want to do because Jesus Christ broke the power of sin and all its relations. It has no more dominion over me, and it cannot make me do what I will not do.

That includes how much I pray.

"How much do you pray, Brother Roberson?"

As much as I want to.

"I heard you got beat out of prayer last month."

That is because I wanted to get beat out of prayer.

All unrighteousness is sin. We are not talking about you going to hell or anything, though if you keep covering it up, you may end up there. If we confess it as sin, He is faithful and just. Confess what? The fact that if I am walking in darkness, I am not in fellowship with the Father. John said, "I write these things so you quit sinning."

You need to confess it as sin. He is faithful and just to forgive you because you have admitted the whole mess is wrong and gone before Him with a repentant heart. He is faithful and just to forgive because you are willing to turn now, and He will break its hold over you and cleanse you from all unrighteousness.

Do these kinds of messages make you mad? This is the Word of God, the two-edged sword, dividing asunder bone and marrow, soul and spirit. Does it make you mad when it cuts away at your life and you know it is right, so it irritates you?

James Shows That Temptation Requires Wisdom Without Wavering

Let us go to James and look at the devil's temptation for a moment.

James 1:1 says:

James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ,
to the twelve tribes which are scattered abroad,
greeting.

My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations;
Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.
But let patience have her perfect work,
that ye may be perfect and entire, wanting nothing.

When the devil pulls your life on trial and attempts a temptation, especially in the area of sin, lust for other things, or the deceitfulness of riches, he pulls you into a court of law and indicts your flesh. He says, "I am going to rule."

But James says the trying of your faith works patience. Let patience have her perfect work, that you may be perfect, entire, and lacking nothing.

Then he says:

If any of you lack wisdom,
let him ask of God,
that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not;
and it shall be given him.

What wisdom? In the middle of this temptation, when the devil has indicted your flesh and you want to sin so badly, ask God. He gives to all men liberally and brings no reproach with Him.

But notice:

Let him ask in faith, nothing wavering.
For he that wavereth is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed.
For let not that man think that he shall receive any thing of the Lord.
A double minded man is unstable in all his ways.

Just in case you want to know what kind of wisdom you are asking for, go to James 3:17:

But the wisdom that is from above is first pure,
then peaceable, gentle, and easy to be intreated,
full of mercy and good fruits,
without partiality, and without hypocrisy.

I am in the middle of this test, and my flesh has been indicted. It wants me to sin. It has almost convinced me there is hardly any avenue out of it. James says to ask for wisdom. The wisdom from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, easy to be entreated, full of mercy and good fruits, without partiality and without hypocrisy.

That means the only avenue I will take out of that trial is the avenue that is pure, peaceable, gentle, easy to be entreated, and without hypocrisy. I am not going to take your money and buy my way out. I am not going to sin and claim grace covers it. I am not going to live in promiscuous grace or premeditated repentance. He will deliver me.

Lust Conceives Only When We Cooperate With It

James 1:13 says:

Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God:
for God cannot be tempted with evil,
neither tempteth he any man.

The word tempted also includes testings and trials. Many of them are caused by the lust of the flesh. But let no man say when he is tempted, tested, or tried, "I am tempted, tested, or tried by God." God cannot be tempted, tested, or tried with evil, and neither does He tempt, test, or try any man with evil.

"Brother Roberson, God allowed that disease to come on me to teach me a valuable lesson."

No. He does not tempt you with sin, and He is not tempted with it. Nor does He tempt you with any of the cohorts and fruits of death. All that belongs to the devil.

No matter how much your flesh and the devil work on your mind, looking for a reason and saying, "God must have allowed this to come on me. It must be because of the person next to me in the hospital bed. He wanted me to witness to him," no. God is not tempted with that mess. He does not use it to tempt any man. He is my answer, not my problem.

It should be a cold day in hell before we are so hard-hearted that the only time we learn anything is when we are dying.

America is being tried. She is entering into persecution. The Church let it happen. It is so sad that we could not turn our faces toward heaven and love God and worship Him when we had two chickens in the pot, three cars in the garage, and a swimming pool in the backyard. It is sad that we could not lift our faces and worship Him for anything but materialism and the promiscuous grace life we seemed to be allowed to live in this generation.

Many people will bow their knee to Jesus in this generation, but it will not be because of His best. I am glad we started three years ago badgering people to bow their knee, worship God relentlessly, and pray in the Holy Ghost.

James 1:14 says:

But every man is tempted,
when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.

Every man begins to fall to temptation when he is drawn away by his own lust and enticed. Enticed means to be so excited about the prospect of sin that you are willing to flirt with it for the possibility of gratifying the flesh.

Verse 15:

Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin:
and sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death.

He uses the terminology of conception. When a woman conceives, a seed is in her womb and begins to grow. Conception has taken place. When you begin to flirt with and romance sin, remember that the woman did not get pregnant by herself. She met somebody. There was romance, engagement, and then conception.

Sin cannot make you sin by itself. You have to cooperate with it. No more than a woman gets pregnant by herself, sin cannot dominate you without your cooperation.

When lust conceives, it brings forth sin. Just as a child is born with the DNA and programming for an entire human being, your kind of lust, when it conceives, has a program planted in your soul. It intends to take your emotions and actions over before it is finished.

Keep attacking people. Keep running them down. Keep claiming you are walking in light. Keep flirting. Keep mishandling sin. Keep claiming you could not help it. But I can tell you exactly how the Holy Spirit mortifies the deeds of the body. I can tell you how to turn yourself over to Him, and He will so put your flesh to death that its silence will be resounding from now and forever.

If you do not, it is because you do not want to.

Lust conceives and brings forth sin. When sin comes to full term and takes you over, it brings forth its child, which is death. You started out born again, fell into temptation, and if that thing gets away from you, it can deliver you back into death.

Verse 16 says:

Do not err, my beloved brethren.
Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above,
and cometh down from the Father of lights,
with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning.

"Shadow of turning" comes from a sundial. How long do you have to stand and stare at a sundial to see the shadow turn? It is very slow. But in God there is no variableness at all, not even a shadow of turning. He is constant. He is eternity. He changes not. He is the same yesterday, today, and forever because His Word changes not.

Do not be mistaken on this point. Every good and perfect gift comes down from the Father of lights, in whom there is no darkness, no variableness, and no shadow of turning.

A man enters temptation when his own lust causes him to begin flirting with sin. But God is not the source of that temptation. God is the answer.

I have some good news for you: sin shall not have dominion over you. The law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus has made me free from the dominance of the flesh, from Satan's hierarchy, and from the law of sin and death. Neither Satan nor my flesh can make me do what I will not do.